

Grammar

Simple Present Tense

Read the following sentences.

My mother *makes* small paper animals.

Revathi *paints* beautiful pictures and *practises* origami as a hobby.

The highlighted verbs in these sentences are in the **simple present tense**.

The simple present tense tells us about habitual actions. The simple present tense is also used to talk about things that are always true. For example,

The earth *is* a sphere.

The sun *rises* in the east.

Sentences in the simple present tense are in the following pattern:

subject + present tense form of the verb + other elements in the sentence

Subject	Present tense form of the verb	Rest of the sentence
Revathi	is	an artist.
Taher and Reem	run	to Revathi.
Revathi's father	asks	everyone to have lunch.

In the simple present tense, the verb changes according to the person and number of the subject. Singular subjects are followed by singular verbs, whereas plural subjects are followed by plural verbs. The subject can be a noun, a noun phrase or a pronoun.

Grandfather *makes* tasty food for Reem and Taher.

They *practise* origami.

The kittens *are* naughty.

F Fill in the blanks with the correct options.

1. Neelima *practises* (practise/practises) sitar every day.
2. Each packet *contains* (contains/contain) ten slices of bread.
3. Bidisha, Afsana and Rupal *are* (is/are) the toppers.
4. My mother *has* (have/has) two mobile phones.

5. This aircraft flies (flies/fly) from Bengaluru to Hyderabad every day.
6. We always carry (carry/carries) umbrellas in our bags.
7. When it is (are/is) day in India, it are (is/are) night in the United States.
8. My parents work (work/works) really hard all the time.

G Rewrite the following sentences in the simple present tense.

1. The fish moved fast.
2. My sister watched television every day.
3. The shepherd called his dog Bruno.
4. Arjit listened to music every day.
5. The children liked to eat salad.
6. We watched the news every morning.
7. I took my dog for a walk in the evening.
8. The bicycle belonged to me.
9. My uncle worked in the telecom department.
10. Preeti and Harsha enjoyed skipping rope.



Listening

H Listen to the audio of a passage on trench warfare carefully. Then, answer the questions that follow.

1. What is 'trench warfare'?
2. What problems do the soldiers face in the trenches?
3. How do the soldiers spend their time in the trenches?
4. What kind of work do the soldiers do when they are not fighting?

Speaking

- I** Reem and Taher were inspired by watching a movie. Think of a movie that you enjoyed watching. Why did you like it? Discuss in groups of four.

1. Margaret is showing Symptoms of a common cold.
2. Our math teacher uses the abacus as a teaching tool.
3. My father is working at his worktable.
4. The Kargil War Memorial was built in 1994.
5. Nations should exist in Peace and harmony.
6. Bob Dylan's artworks have been exhibited in New York.
7. The magician did not want to reveal the secrets behind his tricks.
8. Mr Singh's stories are really touching.



Antonyms

Look at the following sentence.

The folding of paper aims to *reveal* and *conceal* the coloured side of it.

The highlighted words are **antonyms**. Words that are opposite in meaning are known as antonyms. Look at the list of words in the first column and their antonyms in the second column.

gentle	rough
victory	defeat
miser	spendthrift
weak	powerful

E Match the words in Column A with their antonyms in Column B.

- | A | B |
|---------------|----------------|
| 1. abundant ✓ | a. cowardly 4 |
| 2. guilty | b. cheerful 10 |
| 3. borrow | c. lend 3 |
| 4. rare | d. scarce 1 |
| 5. tame | e. succeed 8 |
| 6. accept ✓ | f. common 4 |
| 7. brave | g. refuse 6 |
| 8. fail | h. captivity 9 |
| 9. freedom | i. innocent 2 |
| 10. gloomy | j. wild 5 |

Comprehension

A Complete the following sentences.

1. The movie that Reem and Taher were watching was about
2. Sadako Sasaki folded
3. Revathi practised origami
4. Sadako's memorial is at
5. Today, origami cranes are also a symbol of
6. While making origami, Akira Yoshizawa avoided
7. Akira Yoshizawa's personal origami technique is known as
8. The children also wanted to fold

B Answer the following questions.

1. How did Reem and Taher come to know about Sadako's story?
2. Why did Sadako fold paper cranes?
3. Who was Akira Yoshizawa? Why did he decide to use origami as a teaching tool?
4. What is 'wet-folding'?
5. How is regular origami paper different from that used in the wet-folding technique?

C Think and answer.

1. Reem said, 'We can ask the other kids to come join us. Then it will bring good luck for us all.' What does this tell us about Reem?
2. Why do you think people believe in good luck charms like paper cranes?

Vocabulary

Expressions from the Text

D Fill in the blanks with the correct words or phrases from the box.

peace and harmony reveal symptoms exhibited
touching Memorial teaching tool worktable

Revathi began,

'There was a man in Japan called Akira

Yoshizawa. He

worked at a factory

and his job was to

teach his juniors basic

geometry. To make

teaching and learning

easier, Yoshizawa

decided to use paper

folding as a teaching

tool. As a child he

had learnt how to

make origami and

thought it was helpful

in teaching and

learning mathematics. Yoshizawa's work was exhibited

in several cities like Tokyo, New York and Amsterdam.

His personal method is known as "wet-folding", and he

never used scissors or glue to make the paper shapes.'

'What is wet-folding?' asked Taher. 'In the wet-

folding method, the paper has to be dampened before

making the fold. This makes it soft, and it is then easier

to shape the paper into figures,' said Revathi. 'The

paper used for this method of folding is slightly thicker

than the regular origami paper. I have some sheets of

such paper with me. I'll show it to you.'

'Regular origami paper is usually coloured on one

side and white on the other. The folding of paper aims

to reveal and conceal the coloured side of the paper

according to the design,' said Revathi.

After lunch, the four of them sat around a

worktable, busily folding paper. 'We want to make a

thousand paper cranes too!' said Taher. Revathi and her

father gladly agreed to help. 'We can ask the other kids

to come join us. Then it will bring good luck for us all,'

said Reem happily.



What is wet-folding?

exhibited: displayed
dampened: made slightly wet
reveal: cause something to be
seen
conceal: hide



Statue of Sadako at the Children's Peace Monument in Hiroshima, Japan

Do paper cranes really bring good luck, Mother?

memorial: (here) a statue constructed to remind people about a person or an event
auspicious: lucky
harmony: a situation in which people live without any violence or disagreement
interrupted: made to stop for a short period

Reem's mother, Revathi, was an artist. She painted beautiful pictures and practised origami as a hobby.

The two children went running to where Revathi was painting. 'Mother, we watched the movie you asked us to. We want to know more about paper cranes and how they bring good luck,' said Reem.

Revathi put her paintbrush down and said, 'Sure. Come sit down.' The children sat on the sofa while Revathi continued, 'Sadako's story is so touching. She has a memorial in her honour at a park in Japan. At the memorial, people still fold paper cranes in the memory of those who died due to radiation sickness.'

'But why cranes?' asked Taher curiously.

'In Japan, cranes are considered auspicious. Like the dragon or the tortoise, they are believed to live for a thousand years. Some say that a person who successfully folds a thousand paper cranes is granted one wish. Some others say that folding cranes brings good luck, health and recovery from illness to the person who folds them,' said Revathi.

'A thousand paper cranes are so many! Where do they keep them?' asked Taher, concerned.

'The paper cranes are first folded and then tied together with strings. They are also used as decorations in homes and are popular gifts in Japan,' said Revathi.

'Do paper cranes really bring good luck, Mother?' asked Reem.

'I would like to believe that they do,' replied her mother. 'Today they are also a symbol of world peace and harmony.'

The conversation was interrupted by Revathi's father who asked the children to have lunch.

'Come children - Revathi, you too - let's hear more of your stories over lunch.'

'Yes, Papa,' said Revathi. 'Come children, I'll tell you about a very famous origami master next.'

The excited children immediately ran to wash their hands. Then they rushed to sit down at the table.

A Thousand Origami Cranes



01

The word origami comes from the Japanese words ori meaning 'folding' and kami meaning 'paper'. The art of creating tiny paper crafts or shapes by folding paper is called origami. Read the chapter to find out how the art of origami has brought comfort and peace to many people around the world.

It was summer vacation in school. Reem and Taher were watching a movie in Reem's house. It was about a twelve-year-old Japanese girl called Sadako Sasaki who died due to radiation sickness in 1955.

Sadako was only two years old when atom bombs were dropped about two kilometres away from her home in Japan. When she was eleven years old, symptoms of the 'bomb disease' started appearing on her body. The doctors told her that she would probably live for another year.

It is a popular belief in Japan that good luck and fortune favours anyone who folds a thousand paper cranes. This made little Sadako fold paper cranes using any paper that she found around her. The movie showed that Sadako had folded about six hundred paper cranes before she died. The rest of the cranes were folded by her friends and well-wishers and buried along with her when she died.

'Such a touching movie!' said Reem.

'I wonder why the Japanese fold paper to make cranes,' said Taher.

'My mother makes small paper animals. Let's go ask her,' said Reem promptly.

**I wonder why
the Japanese
fold paper
to make
cranes.**

radiation sickness: a disease caused due to exposure to radioactive chemicals (at very high doses, these chemicals harm the human body and hinder its proper functioning)
symptoms: signs in one's body that show that one is not healthy
touching: (here) arousing feelings of sympathy
promptly: without any delay